

FREE GUIDE



The Hair Porosity Cheat Sheet

Find your Type 4 porosity in 60 seconds — and know exactly what to do next.

by Schicgirl

START HERE

Why Porosity Changes Everything

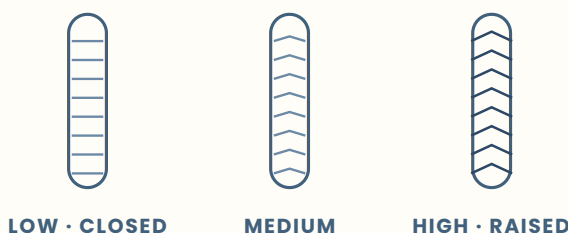
If your hair drinks up product and still feels dry by noon — or water just beads on top and never sinks in — you are not doing it wrong. You simply have not matched your routine to your porosity yet.

In the next ten minutes you will learn what porosity is, test yours at home, and walk away knowing exactly how to layer, seal and care for your crown. One small piece of knowledge, and your whole routine finally makes sense.

YOUR POROSITY AFFECTS ✓ Hydration ✓ Product absorption ✓ Drying time ✓ Product build-up
✓ Moisture retention

WHAT POROSITY ACTUALLY MEANS

Porosity is how easily your hair absorbs and holds moisture. It comes down to your **cuticle** — the outer layer of tiny overlapping scales on every strand. When the cuticle lies flat and tight, water is slow to get in but stays beautifully once it does. When it is raised or has gaps, water rushes in and escapes just as fast.



THE 60-SECOND TEST

- **Float test:** drop a clean, product-free shed strand into a glass of room-temperature water. Floats after a few minutes → **low**. Sinks slowly → **medium**. Sinks fast → **high**.
- **Spray test:** mist a small dry section. Beads on top → low. Absorbs steadily → medium. Vanishes instantly → high.

SCHICGIRL TIP

Treat these as quick indicators, not lab results. How your hair behaves over a few wash days tells you the most — and many of us are a mix, with a different feel at the nape or edges.

Low & Medium Porosity

Low Porosity

CLOSED, TIGHT CUTICLE · THE DOOR IS SHUT



YOU'LL NOTICE

Water beads on top, products sit and pile up, hair takes a long time to dry, can feel coated.

DO THIS

Use gentle heat when deep conditioning. Choose light, water-based, humectant-rich products. Clarify regularly so nothing blocks the door.

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Moisture is slow to enter — but once it's in, it stays well.

YOUR METHOD

LCO — Liquid, Cream, Oil. Keep every layer light.

Medium Porosity

SLIGHTLY RAISED CUTICLE · BALANCED



YOU'LL NOTICE

Water absorbs at a normal rate, styles hold well, hair feels easy to manage.

DO THIS

Keep a steady routine, add light protein occasionally, and avoid over-treating. Don't fix what isn't broken.

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Moisture moves in and out at a healthy, even pace.

YOUR METHOD

LCO or LOC — whichever feels best on the day.

High Porosity & Quick Compare

High Porosity

RAISED OR GAPPED CUTICLE · THE DOOR IS WIDE OPEN



YOU'LL NOTICE

Water disappears instantly, hair dries fast, drinks product yet feels dry again quickly, prone to frizz and breakage.

DO THIS

Seal within minutes. Use richer creams and butters, add light protein regularly, and finish with a cool rinse to close the cuticle.

WHAT'S HAPPENING

You absorb everything and hold very little — retention is the whole game.

YOUR METHOD

LOC — Liquid, Oil, Cream, heaviest layer last.

QUICK COMPARISON

	Low	Medium	High
Water enters	Slowly	Steadily	Instantly
Drying time	Very slow	Normal	Very fast
Products	Sit on top	Absorb well	Vanish fast
Best method	LCO	LCO / LOC	LOC
Top need	Heat + light layers	Consistency	Seal fast + protein

Routines & Common Mistakes

YOUR RECOMMENDED ROUTINE

- **Low:** Cleanse → deep condition *with heat* (20–40 min) → light leave-in → light cream → light oil. Refresh with a water mist between washes.
- **Medium:** Cleanse → weekly deep condition → leave-in → cream → oil. Add light protein every 4–6 weeks.
- **High:** Cleanse → moisturising deep condition → leave-in → oil → rich cream, sealing ends extra → light protein every ~4 weeks, moisture within 48h. Cool rinse.

COMMON MISTAKES — AND THE FIX

The mistake	The fix
Hydrating with oil instead of water	Start with water; oil only <i>seals</i> what's already there
Skipping the seal	Always lock moisture in with an oil or cream
Low porosity, no heat	Add gentle heat so product can finally penetrate
High porosity, no protein	Add light protein to fill the gaps in the cuticle
Heavy butters first on low porosity	They block the door — go light first, seal last
Glycerin in cold, dry air	It can pull moisture out; ease off in winter

YOUR NEXT 10 MINUTES

Your Action Plan

Tick your answers, then act on them today — this is where results begin.

MY POROSITY IS

- ☐ Low
- ☐ Medium
- ☐ High

MY NEXT STEP

- ☐ Add heat (low)
- ☐ Clarify build-up
- ☐ Use lighter products
- ☐ Seal faster after misting
- ☐ Add light protein (high)

QUICK WIN TONIGHT

Mist your hair with water, seal the driest sections with a little oil, and sleep in satin. That one habit alone changes how your hair feels by morning.

READY FOR THE FULL SYSTEM?

Hydrated — The Complete Type 4 Hydration Handbook takes you all the way: the frameworks, routines, DIY recipes, troubleshooting and worksheets, step by step.

Join the free community at facebook.com/schicgirl and explore everything at schicgirl.me. Your crown deserves knowledge, not guesswork. — Schicgirl

Get Hydrated — the complete guide →

CONTINUE YOUR HAIR JOURNEY

Ready for the Next Step?

Now that you understand your porosity, you hold the key to *why* your hair drinks up — or resists — moisture.

The natural next step is learning exactly how to work with it, so dryness stops being a daily battle.

RECOMMENDED NEXT RESOURCE

Stop Dry Hair

End the cycle of constant dryness and finally keep your Type 4 hair soft, supple, and hydrated for days.

If you enjoyed this guide and want a complete step-by-step system, this resource was created for you.

INSIDE YOU'LL DISCOVER

- ✓ Why your hair keeps drying out — and the real root cause behind it
- ✓ How to match your moisture routine to your porosity
- ✓ The layering method that locks hydration in for days
- ✓ The everyday habits quietly sabotaging your moisture
- ✓ A simple, repeatable routine that keeps your hair soft and supple

Who it's for: Anyone whose Type 4 hair feels dry, brittle, or thirsty no matter what they try.

If your cheat sheet revealed high (or low) porosity, this is the gentlest place to begin.

AVAILABLE AT selar.com/m/schicgirl

*You've already taken the most important step — choosing to understand your hair.
We'll be here for every step that follows.*

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